Protecting Every Citizen's Vote

GS II

- Electoral rolls contain the names of people eligible to vote. Over time, deaths, migration and other changes can make these lists inaccurate. Regular revision is therefore necessary to maintain **accurate electoral rolls** and protect the fairness of elections.
- However, during voter list revision, genuine voters may be removed if officials wrongly identify them as ineligible or fail to verify their details properly. Such **wrongful deletions** can prevent citizens from exercising their democratic rights.
- The problem becomes more serious when affected voters are not given adequate notice, an opportunity to explain their eligibility or a fair process to challenge removal. Without **due process**, an administrative exercise can result in voter exclusion.
- The Election Commission must therefore combine accurate voter verification with transparency, accountability and effective **grievance redressal**. Electoral roll revision strengthens democracy only when errors can be corrected and eligible citizens are protected from wrongful exclusion.

Accurate electoral rolls protect election integrity, but revisions must follow fair procedures so that removing ineligible entries does not deny genuine voters their democratic rights.

Childhood Obesity and Early Prevention

GS II

- Childhood obesity occurs when excessive body fat begins affecting a child's health. **Unhealthy diets**, insufficient physical activity and daily habits can contribute to weight gain, increasing the likelihood that health problems will begin at younger ages.
- Excess body fat can increase the risk of **type 2 diabetes**, high blood pressure, abnormal blood lipids and fatty liver disease. These conditions may develop during childhood and create long-term health risks if not addressed early.
- India faces a **double burden of malnutrition**, where undernutrition and obesity exist simultaneously. This makes public health planning difficult because some children need better access to adequate nutrition while others need support to prevent unhealthy weight gain.
- Prevention requires coordinated action by families, schools and healthcare professionals. Healthier diets, regular physical activity and **behavioural support** should form the foundation, while medical treatment may be considered for adolescents with severe obesity and associated health conditions.

Childhood obesity requires early prevention and family-centred care, while India's nutrition policies must address both inadequate nutrition and rising obesity-related health risks.

Making GST Simpler for Businesses

GS III

- Under the Goods and Services Tax system, businesses must register, file returns, maintain records and claim eligible tax credits. When these procedures become complicated, businesses spend additional time and money meeting **compliance requirements** instead of concentrating on productive activities.
- One difficulty arises with input tax credit, which allows businesses to offset eligible taxes paid on purchases against their tax liability. When credit depends on suppliers filing returns, compliant buyers may face delays that reduce available **working capital**.
- Complex procedures can also increase **administrative discretion**, allowing officials greater control over registrations, inspections and refunds. This may create uncertainty, delays and opportunities for harassment, particularly for small businesses with limited financial and administrative resources.
- Simplifying return filing, automating verification and introducing **faceless assessments** can reduce unnecessary interactions between taxpayers and officials. Predictable tax rates and stronger procedural safeguards can further improve compliance while allowing enforcement to focus on demonstrable violations.

An effective GST system should make compliance simple, protect legitimate tax credits and limit arbitrary enforcement, enabling businesses to operate with greater certainty and trust.